Georgios Tsimos, Ph.D.

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Scientist at **pod**

Website, Google Scholar
LinkedIn: gtsimos

About

I am currently a **Scientist** at **pod**, where we are building an extremely fast and fair, BFT layer for global markets. Towards that, we've been working on the next generation of Web3 protocols, with optimal latency via decoupling the usage of costly consensus.

I received my **PhD** from the **Electrical Engineering** department at the **University of Maryland**, where I was co-advised by **Charalampos Papamanthou** and **Jonathan Katz**. Part of my PhD was completed while I was a visiting researcher at Yale. During my PhD, I researched consensus protocols and how we can improve their asympototical metrics under harsh adversarial conditions.

Education

Ph.D. in Electrical Engineering — **Apr. 2025**
Advisors: Professor **Charalampos Papamanthou** (at Yale), Professor **Jonathan Katz** (at UMD)
University of Maryland, College Park

M.Sc. in Electrical Engineering — **Aug. 2024**
University of Maryland, College Park

M.Sc. in Computer Science — **2018/2019**
Athens University of Economics and Business, Greece — (**Honors**)

B.Sc. (4-year Ptychion) in Computer Science — **2014/2018**
Athens University of Economics and Business, Greece — (**Honors, Valedictorian**)

Research Experience

Scientist — **April 2025- Current**
Pod — *Athens, Greece*

Research Intern — **May 2024- December 2024**
Chainlink Labs — *Remote*

Research Intern in Distributed Systems — **May 2023- August 2023**
Mysten Labs — *Remote*
Notable work: "HammerHead", **[ICDCS'24]**

Visiting Assistant Researcher in Computer Science — **2023- 2024**
Yale University — *New Haven, CT*
Notable work: "Deterministic Byzantine Agreement with Adaptive $O(n \cdot f)$ Communication", **[SODA '24]**

Visiting Researcher — **Dec 2022**
CISPA Helmholtz Center for Information Security — *Saarbrücken, Germany*
Notable work:"Towards Optimal Parallel Broadcast under a Dishonest Majority", **[FC'25]**

Graduate Research Assistant — **2019 — 2025**
Maryland Cybersecurity Center (MC2 Lab) — *University of Maryland, College Park, MD*

Publications

(*Author names appear mainly in alphabetical order*)

P. Jovanovic and L. Kokoris Kogias and A. Sonnino and **G. T.** and P. Vander Vos:
"BlueBottle: Fast and Robust Blockchains through Subsystem Specialization" — submitted

G. T.: — **manuscript**
"Improving Round and Communication Metrics in Consensus" — **PhD Dissertation, 2025**

D. Collins and S. Duan and J. Loss and C. Papamanthou and **G. T.** and H. Wang: — Partially while visiting CISPA
"Towards Optimal Parallel Broadcast under a Dishonest Majority" — Published: **Financial Crypto 2025**

A. Alexandru and J. Loss and C. Papamanthou and **G. T.** and B. Wagner: — Partially while at Yale
"Sublinear-Round Broadcast without Trusted Setup" — Published: **SODA 2025**

G. T. and A. Tsichidis and A. Sonnino and L. Kokoris-Kogias: — During Internship at Mysten Labs
"HammerHead: Leader Reputation for Dynamic Scheduling" — Published: **ICDCS 2024**

F. Elsheimy and **G. T.** and C. Papamanthou: — While at Yale
"Deterministic Byzantine Agreement with Adaptive $O(n \cdot f)$ Communication" — Published: **SODA 2024**

A. Alexandru and J. Loss and C. Papamanthou and **G. T.**:
"Sublinear-Round Broadcast without Trusted Setup against Dishonest Majority" — **manuscript**

G. T. and J. Loss and C. Papamanthou:
"Gossiping For Communication-Efficient Broadcast" — Published: **CRYPTO 2022**

Honors and Awards

Student Travel Grant ($650) **January 2024**
SIAM, SODA

Dean's Fellowship ($15,000) **Aug. 2019 — Jun. 2020**
for the First Year of Ph.D. University of Maryland, College Park, MD

Outstanding Academic Performance Scholarship ($5,000) **June 2022**
Gerondelis Foundation

Award in Memory of Michalis Mitilinaios (€300) **2016- 2017**
for *Top Performance* in selected TCS courses AUEB, Greece

Skills

Communication: English (fluent speaker) , Greek (native) , Spanish (basic communication)

Service to the Community

Program Committees: CCS'26, CCS'25
Reviewer: Eurocrypt'26,JoC'25,JoC'24, Financial Crypto'24, AFT'23, CCS'23, PKC'23,Financial Crypto'23,CCS'22,EuroCrypt'21

References

References can be provided upon request.